

The Ministry of Finance said in a 2006 report that heroin "is being smuggled by Nigerian operators based in Delhi and Mumbai through Indian carriers... in quantities up to 10-20 kg from across the Indo-Pak border".

Nigerians are involved in immigration and job rackets too, sometimes using job sites and shortlisting potential victims. In one such case, one Chinoso Valentine Neebe alias Doughlas posed as a British High Commission official and duped people by offering jobs in the UK. He was arrested after five people from Andhra Pradesh and one from Nepal were caught by immigration officials at Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport in January while boarding a London-bound flight on forged Visa documents. Doughlas and his Hyderabad-based associate Sushant Nayak took Rs 4-6 lakh each from them. The Nigerian menace has stung the Delhi Police and the Central

PARVEEN NEGI



Dirty Deeds

The top Nigerian cons and how they work

Black Dollar Fraud Victims are presented with black-coated dollars worth millions. They are then duped into paying lakhs to buy an expensive liquid to remove the coating.

Credit Card Scams They hack accounts and dupe people into revealing their credit card details on the Internet with lucrative offers. The money is then transferred to different accounts over time.

Drug Peddling Nigerians are regulars at rave parties and have networks with local prostitution rings and beggars.

Lottery Fraud Internet users are trapped into non-existent lottery wins and end up losing lakhs on the pretext of money transfer charges.

Job Fraud Using job sites, they shortlist potential victims. An email is then sent on behalf of leading companies, asking the candidates to pay money for air travel for interviews and processing applications.

Gifts Fraud They dupe people online by charging a fee for delivering gifts worth millions that never materialise.

Immigration Scam Disguised as representatives of sought-after destinations like the US or the UK, they offer lucrative jobs and charge lakhs to provide fake documents.

Bureau of Investigation enough for them to put their personnel through a six-week training programme in cybercrime investigation and computer forensics, of which Nigerian Fraud was a significant component.

The Nigerian High Commission says there are 3,000 of their citizens in India. What proportion of this population is criminal remains anybody's guess but a stolen passport or expired Visa remains the standard alibi for a Nigerian arrested on a criminal charge. "You need at least five men to

“One of the major problems is that Indian authorities do not pay for the tickets while deporting Nigerians back after the arrest.”

INNOCENT O. UDEH, *Minister (Consular and Education) at the Nigerian High Commission*

apprehend one and they are very uncooperative," says L.N. Rao, ACP in Delhi Police's Special Cell. Urban legend adds to the trouble. Says one Narcotics Control Bureau officer: "Sometimes constables are scared of dealing with Nigerians because they think they suffer from AIDS." Others say that many Nigerian women start stripping and screaming, feigning sexual assault, during questioning.

Law enforcers say they get little support from the Nigerian High Commission. Minister of Consular and Education matters at the Nigerian High Commission in New Delhi, Innocent O. Udeh refutes this. "There are times when Indian security agencies seek information we do not have. How can we provide such information?" he says. What makes this mess unholy is the fact that High Commission operatives have been in the past held for suspicious activities. In 2007, Captain G.A. Ojedokun, defence adviser to the Nigerian envoy, became the first diplomat in the country to be penalised for a crime. He was caught with around Rs 10 crore while taking a flight to Lagos. It's a growing nightmare, and the law has some catching up to do. ■